

App Watch

We look at the myriad changes in the world of mobile and tablet apps, since we met last month



Chrome 27

Chrome 27 is finally here, supporting FileSystem API for helping users sync their data to Drive. Download and install it on your system. <http://dgit.in/LhRFTe>



a partnership which enables users to see tweets in their Yahoo! newsfeed.

What Yahoo and Twitter want to deliver isn't just a barrage of Tweets in your feed, for that's what Twitter is for. Instead, you will only be seeing selective tweets based on your topics of interest. The Tweets making their way into your Yahoo Newsfeed will come from various sources such as sports, movies, music, business and any other topic of news you could possibly think of. The Yahoo! newsfeed Tweet-integration will start rolling out to US users first, showing up in both their desktop and mobile versions of Yahoo. The rest of the world is going to have to just wait for a little while.

Coming to the Tumblr acquisition, we learnt that in May, Yahoo paid \$1.1 billion to acquire New York-based blogging site, Tumblr. Tumblr was founded by David Karp in the year 2007 in his mother's apartment in New York. Karp was just 21 years old back then, and within a fortnight his service had 75,000 users. By January 2012 it reached a figure of 42 million. There are about 110 million blogs on the site as of today and investors such as Sir Richard Branson have invested \$125 million in the company. Marissa Mayer along with the Board of Directors have agreed that it will let Tumblr function as an independent business.

Elaborating on the Flickr revamp, the new Flickr is quite different from the old, at least at first glance. The first thing that hits you is a revamped UI and a jaw dropping number of new features, all built and running on the trusted user experience that made Flickr so popular. If you're wondering what the new Flickr is all about, here's the lowdown on the changes.

Flickr is now offering 1TB of storage space to all users, regardless of what sort of account you hold or have held. They've even put up a real fancy meter to figure out how many photos you can cram onto your allotted space given the resolution of each image.

There are no more pro accounts on Flickr. Since there aren't any more paid accounts on Flickr. The site throws up ads in between the images. It's a rather jarring visual break when looking at the slick interface that Flickr has designed. That might be a small price to pay for that storage. If you want an ad-free experience, you will need to shell out \$49.99/year. For

more details, refer to our online coverage (<http://dgit.in/16Jpd7A>).

Google I/O 2013

At the annual Google I/O event, the search giant announced a bunch of new offerings including a better music service, improved maps, Hangouts and more. The company introduced Google All Access, a service that will put together all the songs that you already have in your cloud storage along with millions of other tracks available for streaming for a monthly subscription fee of \$10.

By doing this, Google plans to give other competing online music subscription streaming sites like Spotify a run for their money. The service has been available in the US since mid-May, and is expected to roll out in 12 more countries where Google sells music online, including U.K., France and Germany, Australia and New Zealand and more. There is no information on when the service will be available in India.

Google is also adding a whopping 41 features to its social networking site, Google+. There is a new photo-managing tool making an appearance in the service. All users need to do is upload a bunch of photos and Google will automatically reject the ones where people aren't smiling or the image is blurry. Users now have 15GB instead of 5GB storage for full resolution images on the social networking account. Google also announced that Gmail will be receiving Quick Action Buttons, which should make going

through your inbox a whole lot simpler. The Quick Action buttons are designed to get you through your inbox a lot more efficiently and are designed to work with certain types of emails/content. For example, emails that require an RSVP would get the "Yes", "No, and "Maybe" Quick Buttons which will pop up when you hover on the email. Google also said that they would expand this to show information such as flight information or show ratings for restaurants you may have visited or plan to visit.



Along with Quick Action buttons, Google's also integrated its Wallet service with Gmail, making it a lot easier to pay for services and transfer money to contacts. The option is only available to those who have a Google Wallet account (which must be linked to your bank account, or have Google Wallet balance). The feature, as of now, will only be rolled out to American Gmail account holders over the age of 18 years in the coming months.

For details about what all Google unveiled at I/O 2013, refer to our online coverage (<http://dgit.in/10sqCul>).